

Word-count declaration

Manuscript: *A Comparative Analysis of Relational Database Access-Layer Performance in Express.js for PostgreSQL and MySQL* (submission build `ist/ist_main.tex`).

Counted with `texcount` on the seven body sections plus the structured abstract, with each table and figure counted as 200 words per the IST author guidelines.

Component	Count
Body text (7 sections)	12,402
Structured abstract	290
Tables and figures in the main text (11×200)	2,200
Main-text total	14,892

This is under the journal’s 15,000-word limit. The reference list (70 entries) is provided separately. Eleven further tables are placed in the numbered online supplement (`supplement.pdf`, Supplement Tables S1–S11), which is submitted with the manuscript and archived under the same Zenodo DOI as the code and data.

Highlights (5 bullets, each ≤ 85 characters) are in `highlights.tex`.